FLEET TEAM DIGEST

737MAX-FTD-27-23002

Issue Title : Improper Swaging of Bearings - Elevator Buss Assembly

Airplane Model	ATA	Minor Model(s)
737MAX	2731-74	-7, -8, -8200, -9, -BBJ

Other Model(s)	ECCN
	9E991

Originated Date	Last Revised Date	Created On
04/13/2023	09/18/2026	09/18/2026

Estimated Completion Date	Next Update Date
09/21/2026	09/21/2026

Revision Description

Updated Milestone Section to include the release date of the Service Bulletin as well as the Service Bulletin Number.

Description

The purpose of this FTD article is to provide updates on the SRP investigation for the 737 MAX issue of improper swaging of bearings in the elevator buss assembly, which was presented previously at the December 2022 737 Fleet Team Call.

During final assembly, multiple defects were discovered involving installation of bearings specific to the swaging process where the potential for fracture/damage can develop undetected within the crank arm which could adversely affect longevity and result in degraded elevator pitch control performance in the long term.

The improper swaging/installation of bearings, 3 places per side (6 total), did not meet specific model requirements as specified in Boeing drawing 251A2341.

Boeing plans to release a service bulletin to address supplemental information and further operator action from the completion of the SRP.

Status

Updates provided at the December 2022 Fleet Team Call. Next update to be provided after Plan Approval (31-Mar-2023).

Interim Action

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No interim operator action required, as elevators and bearings are maintained by regular lubrication and inspection every 6,000 Flight Hours (per MPD 27-070-00), which would detect any degraded bearings, if present.

Final Action

Final actions to be provided via a Service Bulletin after completion of SRP.

Milestones

Note: Target dates are based upon currently available status and have risk of future revision.

Root Cause Established: 26-Jan-2023
Solution Selected: 26-Jan-2023
Change Committed: TBD
Production Incorporation: L/N 8484 and on are conforming; L/Ns 8111 through 8483 were impacted, with a list of exceptions that were inspected in production
Service Bulletin Available: 09-Nov-2025

Updates:

Service Bulletin Release Date: 12/17/25

Service Bulletin: 737-27A1331

Reference Categories

Reference Type	Reference Number	Revision Number	Reference Date
Drawing	251A2341		

Related Categories

- SRPs - Safety : Service Related Problems in work by Boeing that have an airplane or personal safety impact

Attachments:

a) Bearing Locations

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